

CHESS GROWING IN DIGITAL SPACE

Online chess will feature some of the best players around the world, including Magnus Carlsen, Ding Liren and Ian Nepomniachtchi, **with three Indians** — Arjun Erigaisi, Aravindh Chitambaram and Nihal Sarin — joining them.

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Arjun Erigaisi had made history in February, becoming the first Indian chess player to feature in the Esports World Cup 2025.

Now, Nihal Sarin and Aravindh Chithambaram have followed him, though joining a different team for the coveted esports tournament. The two Grandmasters joined S8UL, one of India's biggest esports companies, for the online chess title, scheduled between July 29 and August 1 in Saudi Arabia.

"Being part of S8UL's lineup for the Esports World Cup reflects how far the game has come and how it continues to evolve," Chithambaram said.

"The fact that a mainstream esports organisation is investing in chess players shows the growing recognition of chess as both a competitive and spectator sport in the digital space."

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and Ian Nepomniachtchi, with three Indians – Erigaisi, Chitambaram and Sarin – joining them.

S8UL, the only Indian organisation selected as a club partner for the tournament, announced that it will compete in Chess, EAFC 25, Tekken 8, Call of Duty (COD): Warzone, and Apex Legends, in its first wave of titles.



TOP 5 DOTA 2 PLAYERS IN INDIA



KRISH
"KRISH" GUPTA



MANAV
"MNZ" KUNTE



MOIN
"NO_CHANC3" IJAZ



VISHAL
"HBK" VERNEKAR



SHAHBAZ
"PINKMAN" HUSSAIN